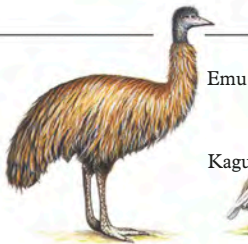


FLIGHTLESS BIRDS



Eye-to-eye
Ostriches' round eyes are nearly as big as tennis balls!



Emu

Kagu

Flying is hard work—it takes a lot of energy to flap wings and lift off the ground. For most birds it is worth the effort because it helps them escape from danger or search for things to eat. But some birds, such as kiwis and kagus, live on islands where there are no enemies, and others run or swim after food instead of flying.

Over millions of years, birds such as ostriches, emus, and penguins have gradually lost the ability to fly.



The shell is about 0.08 inches (two millimeters) thick.

Super egg

Ostriches lay bigger eggs than any other bird: they are 24 times bigger than a chicken's egg! The shell is incredibly strong.



Its tiny wings are hidden under brown, furlike feathers.

The kiwi's nostrils are on the tip of its long beak.

Sniff sniff

The national bird of New Zealand, the kiwi, is one of only a few birds to have a good sense of smell. It sniffs out worms that are in the soil.

Ready, set, go!

Ostriches live on the African grasslands. They cannot fly away from lions and hyenas, but they can run very fast. They sprint at speeds of 45 miles (70 kilometers) per hour—much faster than a galloping horse.

